

PROFESSIONAL DRIVING

Train Dispatch, Train Driving and Diversionary Routes

Revision Guide — EMR Training | EMR PPT 11-01 / 11-03 / 11-04 | Cross-referenced against GERT8000-SS1 Iss 10, GERT8000-S7 Iss 7, GERT8000-TW1 Iss 22, GERT8000-SS2 Iss 7

All rule book content in this guide is sourced exclusively from GERT8000-SS1, S7, TW1 and SS2.

Where the training slides cite a different module than the rule itself actually sits in, the correct module/section is used below (corrections are noted at first use).

Anything not found verbatim or in substance in the rule book — discussion prompts, group exercises, company-policy items — is labelled [Course note] and must not be treated as examinable rule book fact.

Classroom-only activities (flip-chart exercises, video links, open brainstorms with no rule book answer) have been left out of this guide as not directly relevant to on-the-day driving duties.

1. Platform-Train Interface (PTI) & Train Dispatch

The platform-train interface is the area of greatest risk to passenger safety on the railway: 30 people lost their lives in PTI incidents between 2003 and 2013. SS1 (“Station duties and train dispatch”) is the primary rule book module governing everything in this section.

1.1 Key definitions

Source: GERT8000-SS1 §1 — Definitions

- Platform starting signal — see 2.1 below for the full definition.
- PIC of dispatch (person in charge of dispatch) — the dispatch staff member or guard who gives the final ‘ready to start’/‘right away’ indication.
- Dispatch staff — staff (other than the guard) assigned to assist with platform dispatch duties.
- Unstaffed platform — a platform with no dispatch staff provided, where the guard (or the driver, if DO) must carry out all dispatch duties themselves.

1.2 Checking the authority to start

Source: GERT8000-SS1 §3.1 — Checking the authority to start

Before starting, you must always check that one of the following applies: the starting signal (or its banner repeater) is showing a proceed aspect, or the platform ‘OFF’ indicator is illuminated, or you have a movement authority, or the signaller has given you personal authority to pass the signal at danger / pass the end of authority. You must also look back, if safe and possible, when starting away.

1.3 The dispatch corridor

Source: EMR PPT 11-01

The dispatch corridor is the area of space that must be visible to carry out the train safety check. It covers: the full length of the train, the gap between the train and the platform, at least 1500mm (4.92 feet) of clear space from the platform edge, and at least the height of the doors.

1.4 Bell/buzzer codes between guard and driver

Source: EMR PPT 11-01, consistent with SS1 dispatch procedure

Code	Meaning
1-2	'Close doors' — driver must acknowledge by repeating 1-2 before closing the doors.
2	'Ready to start' — driver repeats the code back, checks the starting signal/indicator, then may start the train if safe to do so.

If the buzzer fails on an unstaffed platform, the guard may use a green flag/light to indicate 'ready to start' (or use a cab-to-cab call system, traction dependent).

1.5 Dispatch procedure by scenario

Source: GERT8000-SS1 §3 (3.5–3.15 cover the procedures by configuration) and EMR PPT 11-01

Configuration	Key sequence
Power doors, guard, staffed platform	Dispatch staff confirm clear → 'station work complete' to guard → guard closes doors on '1-2' (or closes them directly if guard-operated) → PIC gives 'train safety check complete' → guard closes local door, gives '2' (ready to start) → driver checks interlock light and starting signal, then starts.
Power doors, guard, unstaffed platform	Same sequence, but the guard also performs the dispatch-staff duties before closing the doors.
Power doors, DO, staffed platform	Dispatch staff confirm clear → 'station work complete' → PIC gives 'close doors' (often shown as 'CD') → driver closes doors, checks interlock light → dispatch staff carry out train safety check → PIC gives 'ready to start' via 'right away' (RA) indication → driver checks starting signal/OFF indicator, then starts.
Power doors, DO, unstaffed platform	Driver performs platform duties only once the starting signal shows proceed or OFF is shown (except on ECS, where doors may close before the signal clears). Uses the 'Z sweep' technique to check the platform. If the signal can't be cleared, signaller authority to pass at danger is needed before dispatch duties begin.
Central door locking (CDL), guard, staffed platform	Dispatch staff confirm clear → 'station work complete' → guard operates CDL → dispatch staff carry out train safety check → PIC gives 'train safety check complete' → guard closes local door, gives '2' (ready to start).
CDL, guard, unstaffed platform	Guard performs both the dispatch-staff and PIC duties as well as their own.
CDL, DO	A DO train fitted with CDL must only be dispatched from a staffed platform — never an unstaffed one. Dispatch staff perform normal duties; PIC gives 'ready to start' (RA indicator, green flag or green lamp).

1.6 Traction interlock light — important caveat

Source: EMR PPT 11-01

The interlock light being illuminated does not necessarily mean it is safe for the train to proceed. It only confirms the doors are interlocked — the driver must still independently check the starting signal/OFF indicator before moving.

1.7 Door defects — when a door is classed as defective

Source: EMR PPT 11-01

- A power-operated door closes other than through normal operation.
- The train starts with someone or something trapped in a door.
- A power-operated door remains open when it should be shut.
- A door comes open during the journey.
- Someone is injured opening/closing a door and the door's condition may have contributed.
- Someone falls from a door during the journey.

- The power-operated door controls become inoperative.
- Central door locking becomes defective.
- The internal passenger 'door open' buttons stay lit while the train is moving.

2. Starting Signals, Movement Authority & Signal Sighting

2.1 Definition of a platform starting signal

Source: GERT8000-SS1 §1 — Definitions (the training slides attribute this to TW1; the rule book actually places it in SS1)

A signal is a platform starting signal if either of the following applies:

1. The longest passenger or empty coaching stock (ECS) train authorised to use the platform would, if stopped at the signal, still have part of its passenger accommodation alongside the platform.
2. The leading end of the train passes over the AWS equipment associated with that signal before the train is dispatched from the station.

Mid-platform signals are always treated as platform starting signals. Company instructions may add to or exempt specific signals from this definition.

2.2 General starting signal rules

Source: EMR PPT 11-01, consistent with SS1 §3.1

- A stop signal at the end of a platform (semaphore or colour light) is the 'starting signal' and must show a proceed aspect before you start the movement.
- You must not move up towards a signal at danger without personal authority from the signaller.
- Where a junction/route indicator is associated with the starting signal, you must confirm the route is set correctly before beginning the movement.

2.3 Position-light / subsidiary signal proceeding with a passenger train

Source: GERT8000-S7 §3.1 — Passenger train at a position-light or semaphore shunting signal (the slides cite S7 for this — confirmed correct)

Unless authority is published, or you are instructed by the signaller (or someone acting on the signaller's instructions), you must not proceed with a passenger train on the authority of a semaphore shunting signal or a position-light signal.

The one exception: you may proceed with a passenger train on the authority of a position-light or semaphore subsidiary signal associated with a main aspect/stop signal if you are entering a permissive platform line.

[Course note — not rule book text] the slides also ask what 'XS' means in this context. That abbreviation does not appear anywhere in S7, or in any other rule book module checked — it could not be verified, so no meaning is given here. Check with your trainer rather than guessing it in an assessment.

2.4 Signals that are difficult to see

Source: GERT8000-S7 §7.1, 7.3, 7.4, 7.5

Situation	Action
General signalling failure / sighting problem (§7.1)	Tell the signaller immediately, stopping the train specially to do so if necessary.
Signal hard to see due to sunlight, streetlights or reflections (§7.3)	Tell the signaller immediately — treated as a signal failure.
Signal already obstructed by trees/foliage/other obstruction (§7.4)	Tell the signaller immediately — treated as a signal failure.
Signal becoming difficult to see due to trees/foliage, not yet a failure (§7.5)	Tell the signaller at the first convenient opportunity. You do NOT need to stop the train specially for this one.

RT3185: when a signal, AWS, ERTMS or TPWS failure or irregularity is reported, both the driver and the signaller must complete form RT3185 with the required details (S7 §7.8(a)). There are exceptions for clear right-side failures.

2.5 Risks of impaired signal sighting

Source: EMR PPT 11-01

- Not being able to identify the signal indication ahead.
- Not knowing if the route ahead is set correctly.
- Movement without authority.
- Signal passed at danger (SPAD).
- Collision with other trains, and delays to the service.

Mitigating actions: only move to the signal when authorised; observe 'OFF' indicators; proceed at caution if authorised, stopping in the distance you can see clear; walk along the platform to where the signal can be seen if safe to do so; contact the signaller to check the signal; report poor sighting conditions as necessary.

2.6 Train signalled towards the wrong route

Source: GERT8000-S7 §1.2 — Train signalled towards a wrong route (the slides cite TW1; the rule actually sits in S7)

If your train has been signalled towards a wrong route, you must stop the train as soon as it is possible to do so safely, and tell the signaller.

3. Driver's Reminder Appliance (DRA)

Source: GERT8000-TW1 §10 — Driver's reminder appliance

When set, the DRA prevents you from obtaining power. Resetting it is a positive action you must take, prompting you to check the signal ahead before moving.

3.1 When the DRA must be set

- TW1 §10.2: when your train is stopped at any signal at danger, or at a block marker with no movement authority (MA) beyond it — this applies whether or not the stop is in a platform.
- TW1 §10.1: when you leave the driving cab at the end of a journey, or when another driver is about to take over the train.

3.2 Resetting the DRA

- Reset only when the signal clears, you receive an MA, or you are authorised to pass the signal/end of authority.
- TW1 §10.3: at a platform with no station starting signal, you must only reset the DRA when you receive the 'ready to start' signal — not simply because a signal elsewhere has cleared.

[Course note — not rule book text] the slides also ask about a fixed "four occasions" for setting the DRA at a platform with no starting signal, the underlying "purpose" rationale, and the risk of over-using the DRA. None of these are stated as such, verbatim, in TW1 §10 or elsewhere in the rule book modules checked — treat them as discussion points for your trainer rather than examinable rule book fact.

4. Onboard Safety Systems: TPWS, AWS, DSD & Vigilance

4.1 TPWS

Source: GERT8000-S7 §6.5 — TPWS operation other than a SPAD

- All TPWS brake applications must be reported to the signaller.
- You must not move the train after a TPWS activation until the signaller gives permission to proceed.
- A 'reset and go' (continue) event — continuing the journey without the signaller's permission after a TPWS activation — is a very serious error.
- If on-track equipment caused the activation, the signaller takes the driver's answers on form RT3188 ('Activation of TPWS or ERTMS trip'), completes it, and reports it to Operations Control.

It is essential the TPWS system is checked as working before the train enters service. If the train is stopped by a TPWS brake demand you didn't initiate, check the in-cab AWS/TPWS indications immediately, and contact the signaller — unless the TPWS activated while approaching buffer stops.

4.2 AWS

Source: EMR PPT 11-03

The Automatic Warning System gives an audible and visual indication. When the cab is activated, the TPWS and AWS control unit self-test at the same time — check this self-test completes correctly before entering service.

4.3 DSD and Vigilance (DVE)

Source: EMR PPT 11-03

- If a driver becomes incapacitated, the DSD applies the emergency brakes.
- If not reset within 60 seconds, an alarm is sent to the signaller via GSM-R.
- On some trains the vigilance alarm links to the power/brake controls, delaying the alarm while the driver is actively using the controls. The timer resets by releasing and reapplying pressure on the DSD.
- When activating the cab, check the vigilance alarm sounds when pressure is released from the DSD.

From a depot: you must not start a journey if DSD/DVE is defective or isolated in any cab that requires it. Elsewhere: you may be permitted to continue with DSD/DVE defective or isolated if you tell the signaller, get permission, and follow the conditions below. During a journey, if it becomes defective: stop immediately, tell the signaller, do not move until instructed, and follow the instructions given.

Competent person (CP) provided?	Permitted speed
No competent person	Passenger train: 60 mph. Freight or OTM: 50 mph.
With a competent person	Normal permissible speed.

If DSD becomes defective at the same time as an AWS, TPWS or ERTMS failure, apply the conditions for that other failure.

4.4 Cab radio

Source: EMR PPT 11-03

Before operating in service, and again after relieving another driver, check the cab radio is correctly configured, the headcode and GSM-R-GB display are correct, and (where required by your company) complete an Echo test to prove the handset works.

5. Shunting Movement Authority — Signal vs. Shunter's Handsignal

Source: GERT8000-SS2 §5.1–5.2 (the slides ask which SS2 rule covers a shunter giving a 'come towards' signal when a multi-road signal clears — this is the answer)

Scenario: a signal clears controlling departure from three roads, but the shunter standing at the signal gives a 'come towards' handsignal. What governs which train may move?

SS2 §5.1: you must only make a movement — even when a signal has cleared — if the shunter has authorised the movement, or has operated a shunting or other indicator which authorises it.

SS2 §5.2: handsignals are given per diagrams SS2.2 (daylight) and SS2.3 (darkness). You must not start or continue a movement unless you clearly understand the shunter's handsignal and are sure it applies to you.

Applied to the scenario: the cleared signal alone does not authorise your specific movement. The shunter's handsignal is what tells you which of the three roads is actually being authorised to move — you must positively identify that the 'come towards' signal is meant for your train before moving.

6. Route & Traction Knowledge, Conducting, and Diversionary Routes

6.1 Route and traction knowledge requirements

Source: GERT8000-TW1 §29 — *Route and traction knowledge requirements*

When working a train, you must have the necessary knowledge of the entire route over which you are to work, or be accompanied by a competent conductor driver. If conducted over an unfamiliar portion of line, you must take note of signals, speed restrictions, ERTMS lineside signs and other features of the line. The conductor driver must instruct you on signals, speed restrictions, gradients, curves, ERTMS DMI indications and other features of the line.

[Course note — not rule book text] the slides list illustrative examples of what route knowledge 'could mean' — whistle boards, low adhesion areas, level crossings, local instructions, OLE neutral sections/power changeovers, platform length and stopping markers, depot stopping markers/fouling points, traction-specific speed restrictions, braking points, and tunnels. This is not a single consolidated rule book list — each item is governed by its own rule in its own module (e.g. whistle boards in TW1 §48, level crossings in TW1 §42.2, OLE neutral sections in module AC). Treat the slide's list as a useful memory aid for what 'route knowledge' covers in practice, not as a verbatim rule book quotation.

6.2 Planned diversions

Source: EMR PPT 11-04

A planned diversion is where the train's normal route is altered in advance and an alternative route provided, with enough notice to alert drivers. These are published in the Weekly Operating Notice (WON) and displayed in notice cases; your diagram or schedule card will also show the diversionary route details. Check this when booking on, and contact your resource/line manager if unsure.

6.3 Unplanned diversions

Source: EMR PPT 11-04

Where a diversion is put in place at short notice (e.g. an emergency or incident), you will be notified by Operations Control, the signaller, or your guard/conductor. If there is insufficient time to notify you in advance, you will be stopped at the junction signal and told the diversionary route by the signaller there.

6.4 Competency, knowledge and route clearance before accepting a diversion

Source: EMR PPT 11-04

- You must be competent to drive the diverted route, knowing permissible speeds, signal locations and station locations.
- Consider the length/formation of your train, the length of sidings/passing loops and station platforms on the diversionary route, and whether it actually reaches your intended destination.
- Route clearance for your specific type of rolling stock is detailed in the Sectional Appendix — it is your responsibility as driver to only accept a diversionary route your train is cleared to use. The signaller/controller may not know your rolling stock type, so you cannot assume they have already checked this for you.
- Where train crew are also required (e.g. guards/conductors on a passenger service), they need the relevant route competency too — check with the guard, if provided, before going over the diverted route.

6.5 Route conducting

Source: EMR PPT 11-04

If a driver does not sign a portion of the route, a route conductor is provided where it isn't practical to roster a different driver for the whole diagram. The route conductor must be a competent driver who

signs that route. On some operators, if the conductor also signs the traction, they will drive the train for the relevant portion themselves. A traction conductor (signing traction but not route) also exists, though this is now rare. Companies set their own restrictions on which drivers (e.g. newly-qualified/PQA drivers, or freight vs. passenger drivers) may carry out conducting duties.

When conducting: don't become a distraction, follow cab etiquette, and remember the driver being conducted is concentrating on an unfamiliar route while responding to your instructions — monitor that they are responding correctly.

7. Acceleration, Braking, Stopping & Handing Over

7.1 Before starting a journey

Source: EMR PPT 11-03 / your company's traction manual

Even on a train already in service, check before every start that the train is complete and ready: documentation (e.g. defect book, prep slip), and on a freight train, a brake continuity test.

7.2 Brake continuity testing for freight trains

Brake continuity testing checks the automatic braking system is operating correctly throughout the train. On multiple-unit trains, follow your company's operating instructions (some units self-test). It must be carried out:

- During train preparation and during train mobilisation.
- After coupling additional units, and after uncoupling units.

On locomotive-hauled trains, additionally: when a locomotive is coupled to the train; after a brake defect has been repaired; after a train has been left unattended with the traction unit shut down; whenever a vehicle is uncoupled, unless it is uncoupled from the extreme rear.

7.3 Handing over to / being relieved by another driver

Source: EMR PPT 11-03

Being relieved — before leaving the cab: move the brake controller to 'full service', set the DRA (if fitted), move the direction selector to 'OFF', remove your driving key/master key, and close the cab door securely behind you if the relieving driver isn't present yet. If the relieving driver is not at the location, you must remain with the train.

What to tell the relieving driver: any known defects (reported or rectified), the train's formation, its driving characteristics, any poor railhead conditions affecting safe running, any dangerous or exceptional loads being carried, alterations to the service/formation, the indication of the previous signal if no starting signal is provided, any instructions from the signaller, and any other operationally relevant information.

7.4 Documentation for dangerous or exceptional loads

Source: EMR PPT 11-01

When driving a freight train carrying a dangerous or exceptional load, you should be in possession of the associated documentation — form RT3973 — describing the load and any restrictions on working the train during the journey.

7.5 Accelerating

Source: EMR PPT 11-03

Build up speed gradually: this reduces strain on traction components and the risk of 'snatching' at couplings (particularly on freight trains), reduces wheel slip, and reduces the risk of damage to wheels and the railhead. When starting, control the train to prevent 'roll back' before forward movement is achieved — power must be applied before the brakes can be released.

7.6 Braking

Source: EMR PPT 11-03

Braking efficiency is mainly affected by weight and speed. In addition to pre-start brake tests, you'll be required to carry out running brake tests as detailed in your company's policy and the rule book. A smooth, progressive approach helps braking efficiency, just as it does for acceleration.

Braking on gradients

Sudden or excessive brake applications are inefficient against the train's momentum, and can cause wheel slide (insufficient grip to overcome momentum) or overheating of brake components. On a downhill gradient, the train takes longer to stop and needs more brake force — start braking earlier and apply additional force.

7.7 Stopping correctly

Source: EMR PPT 11-03

The most important thing when stopping is bringing the train to a stand safely at the correct point — this could be a station car stop marker, before a buffer stop, behind another train, or at a stop signal. It is forbidden for you, your guard, or dispatch staff to open doors to allow passengers in or out of a moving train.

New-style stop marker boards: if numbers appear above the coach-number markings, this indicates the class (type) of train the board applies to. Not all boards have been replaced — continue to comply with existing black-and-white markers where still provided.

7.8 Abnormal brake application — what to check

Source: EMR PPT 11-03

If your train stops due to a brake application you did not initiate:

3. Immediately check the in-cab indications, such as AWS/TPWS.
4. If AWS or TPWS has intervened, contact the signaller immediately — unless the TPWS activation occurred while approaching buffer stops.
5. If AWS/TPWS did not cause it, find out whether the guard or the passenger communication apparatus applied the brake.
6. If none of these caused it, check whether your train is complete.

7.9 Low railhead adhesion

Source: EMR PPT 11-01

Low adhesion can be caused by: contamination from oils or diesel fuel, leaf fall, rainfall (particularly after an extended dry period), and snow or ice. Manage acceleration and braking accordingly — smoother, earlier, and less aggressive control inputs reduce the risk of wheel slip/slide in these conditions.

7.10 Timetable adherence

Source: EMR PPT 11-01

As a professional driver, it's your responsibility to check your scheduled time and run to it where possible. Your diagram/schedule card shows key timings — for example a station stop, or the time a freight/ECS train should be at a signal, junction or crossover. Passenger trains should never leave a station before their scheduled time, even if given the 'right-away' or 'ready to start' signal early.

[Course note — not rule book text] the slides pose 'What is Public Time and Working Time Table (WTT) Time?' as a discussion question without giving a rule book definition in the deck itself. No definition for these terms was found in the cross-referenced rule book modules (SS1/S7/TW1/SS2) — raise this with your trainer if it's expected to be examined.

7.11 Approaching cautionary and danger aspects

Source: EMR PPT 11-01

React positively to the first cautionary aspect encountered, whether expected or not. Take particular care approaching a danger aspect — an inadvertent SPAD has severe consequences for the service and for other operators on the same infrastructure.

8. Revision Questions

Only questions with a confirmed rule book or course-source answer are included here. Where the slides posed a question with no verifiable rule book answer (the meaning of 'XS', a fixed 'four occasions' for setting the DRA, the purpose/over-use risk of the DRA, and the definition of Public Time vs. Working Timetable Time), it has been left out of this revision set rather than answered with an invented fact — see the [Course note] callouts in the relevant sections above.

Q1. Why does the platform-train interface (PTI) matter so much?

Answer: Because it is the area of greatest risk to passenger safety on the railway — 30 people lost their lives in PTI incidents between 2003 and 2013.

Source: EMR PPT 11-01

Q2. What is the 'PIC of dispatch'?

Answer: The person in charge of dispatch — the dispatch staff member or guard who gives the final 'ready to start'/'right away' indication.

Source: GERT8000-SS1 §1

Q3. What is an 'unstaffed platform'?

Answer: A platform with no dispatch staff provided, where the guard (or the driver, if working driver-only) must carry out all the dispatch duties themselves.

Source: GERT8000-SS1 §1

Q4. Before starting a train, what must you check?

Answer: That the starting signal (or its banner repeater) shows a proceed aspect, or the platform 'OFF' indicator is illuminated, or you have a movement authority, or the signaller has given personal authority to pass the signal at danger / end of authority. You must also look back, if safe and possible, when starting away.

Source: GERT8000-SS1 §3.1

Q5. What must the dispatch corridor include?

Answer: The full length of the train, the gap between the train and the platform, at least 1500mm (4.92 feet) of clear space from the platform edge, and at least the height of the doors.

Source: EMR PPT 11-01

Q6. What do buzzer codes '1-2' and '2' mean?

Answer: '1-2' means 'close doors' (the driver must acknowledge by repeating 1-2 before closing). '2' means 'ready to start' (the driver repeats it back, checks the starting signal, then starts if safe).

Source: EMR PPT 11-01

Q7. If the buzzer fails on an unstaffed platform, how else can the guard give 'ready to start'?

Answer: By using a green flag or green light (or a cab-to-cab call system, depending on the traction).

Source: EMR PPT 11-01

Q8. Does an illuminated traction interlock light guarantee it is safe to proceed?

Answer: No. It only confirms the doors are interlocked — the driver must still independently check the starting signal or OFF indicator before moving.

Source: EMR PPT 11-01

Q9. From what type of platform must a driver-only (DO) train fitted with central door locking (CDL) be dispatched?

Answer: A staffed platform only — never an unstaffed one.

Source: EMR PPT 11-01

Q10. Give three circumstances in which a train door must be classed as defective.

Answer: Any three of: a power-operated door closes other than through normal operation; the train starts with someone/something trapped in a door; a power-operated door stays open when it should be shut; a door opens during the journey; someone is injured opening/closing a door and its condition may have contributed; someone falls from a door during the journey; the power-operated door controls become inoperative; central door locking becomes defective; the internal 'door open' buttons stay lit while moving.

Source: EMR PPT 11-01

Q11. The training slides say the 'platform starting signal' is a TW1 rule. Is that correct?

Answer: No — the definition actually sits in SS1 §1 (Definitions), not TW1. This is one of the citation corrections made in this guide.

Source: GERT8000-SS1 §1

Q12. What are the two conditions that make a signal a 'platform starting signal'?

Answer: (1) The longest passenger/ECS train authorised to use the platform would, if stopped at the signal, still have part of its passenger accommodation alongside the platform; or (2) the leading end of the train passes over the AWS equipment for that signal before the train is dispatched. Mid-platform signals are always treated as platform starting signals.

Source: GERT8000-SS1 §1

Q13. Can a driver proceed with a passenger train on the authority of a position-light or semaphore shunting signal?

Answer: No, not unless authority is published or the signaller (or someone acting on their instructions) instructs it. The one exception is a position-light or semaphore subsidiary signal associated with a main aspect/stop signal, when entering a permissive platform line.

Source: GERT8000-S7 §3.1

Q14. What must a driver do if a signal is hard to see because of sunlight, streetlights or reflections?

Answer: Tell the signaller immediately — it is treated as a signal failure.

Source: GERT8000-S7 §7.3

Q15. What's the difference between a signal already obstructed by foliage and one only becoming obstructed?

Answer: If it is already obstructed, tell the signaller immediately (treated as a failure). If it is only becoming difficult to see due to trees/foliage, you do not need to stop specially — tell the signaller at the first convenient opportunity.

Source: GERT8000-S7 §7.4 / §7.5

Q16. What form must be completed when a signal, AWS, ERTMS or TPWS failure or irregularity is reported?

Answer: RT3185 — completed jointly by the driver and the signaller (with some exceptions for clear right-side failures).

Source: GERT8000-S7 §7.8

Q17. What must a driver do if their train has been signalled towards the wrong route?

Answer: Stop the train as soon as it is possible to do so safely, and tell the signaller.

Source: GERT8000-S7 §1.2

Q18. When must the DRA be set?

Answer: When your train is stopped at any signal at danger, or at a block marker with no movement authority beyond it (whether or not this is in a platform); and when you leave the cab at the end of a journey or another driver is taking over.

Source: GERT8000-TW1 §10.1 / §10.2

Q19. At a platform with no station starting signal, when must the DRA only be reset?

Answer: Only when you receive the 'ready to start' signal — not simply because a signal elsewhere has cleared.

Source: GERT8000-TW1 §10.3

Q20. What must a driver do after a TPWS brake application?

Answer: Report it to the signaller, and not move the train until the signaller gives permission to proceed.

Source: GERT8000-S7 §6.5

Q21. What is a 'reset and go' event, and why is it serious?

Answer: It's when a driver continues their journey after a TPWS activation without the signaller's permission. It's a very serious error because the train may be moving without the signaller's knowledge that a brake demand occurred.

Source: GERT8000-S7 §6.5

Q22. What form captures a driver's answers after an on-track-equipment TPWS/ERTMS activation?

Answer: RT3188 — 'Activation of TPWS or ERTMS trip'.

Source: GERT8000-S7 §6.5

Q23. If the DSD is defective and no competent person is provided, what is the maximum speed?

Answer: 60 mph for a passenger train; 50 mph for a freight train or OTM. With a competent person provided, the normal permissible speed applies.

Source: EMR PPT 11-03

Q24. A signal clears for all three roads in a siding, but the shunter gives a 'come towards' handsignal. What governs whether you may move?

Answer: You must only move if the shunter has authorised the movement or operated an indicator that authorises it (§5.1) — and you must clearly understand the handsignal and be sure it applies to you (§5.2). The cleared signal alone does not authorise your specific movement.

Source: GERT8000-SS2 §5.1 / §5.2

Q25. What must a driver have before working a route alone, and what's the alternative?

Answer: The necessary route knowledge for the entire route, or be accompanied by a competent conductor driver who instructs them on signals, speed restrictions, gradients, curves and other features of the line.

Source: GERT8000-TW1 §29

Q26. Where are planned diversionary routes published in advance?

Answer: In the Weekly Operating Notice (WON) and displayed in notice cases; details also appear on the driver's diagram or schedule card.

Source: EMR PPT 11-04

Q27. Whose responsibility is it to check a diversionary route is cleared for the train's rolling stock?

Answer: The driver's — route clearance details are in the Sectional Appendix, and the signaller/controller may not know the rolling stock type, so this cannot be assumed to have already been checked for you.

Source: EMR PPT 11-04

Q28. What is a 'route conductor' and when is one provided?

Answer: A competent driver who signs a route a regular driver doesn't, provided when it isn't practical to roster a different driver for the whole diagram. If they also sign the traction, they drive the train for that portion themselves.

Q29. When must brake continuity testing be carried out on a freight train?

Answer: During train preparation, during train mobilisation, after coupling additional units, and after uncoupling units (plus further triggers on locomotive-hauled trains, such as after a brake defect repair or when a vehicle is uncoupled other than from the extreme rear).

Source: EMR PPT 11-03

Q30. Name three things a driver must do before leaving the cab when being relieved.

Answer: Any three of: move the brake controller to 'full service'; set the DRA (if fitted); move the direction selector to 'OFF'; remove the driving key/master key; close the cab door securely if the relieving driver isn't present yet.

Source: EMR PPT 11-03

Q31. What must a driver tell a relieving driver?

Answer: Any known defects, the train's formation and driving characteristics, any poor railhead conditions, any dangerous/exceptional loads, service alterations, the indication of the previous signal if no starting signal is provided, instructions from the signaller, and any other operationally relevant information.

Source: EMR PPT 11-03

Q32. What form documents a dangerous or exceptional load being carried?

Answer: RT3973 — it describes the load and any restrictions on working the train during the journey.

Source: EMR PPT 11-01

Q33. After an abnormal brake application you did not initiate, what order of checks should you carry out?

Answer: Check the in-cab AWS/TPWS indications first; if AWS/TPWS intervened, contact the signaller (unless TPWS triggered while approaching buffer stops); if not AWS/TPWS, check whether the guard or passenger communication apparatus applied the brake; if none of these, check whether your train is complete.

Source: EMR PPT 11-03

Q34. Name four causes of low railhead adhesion.

Answer: Contamination from oils or diesel fuel; leaf fall; rainfall (particularly after an extended dry period); and snow or ice.

Source: EMR PPT 11-01

9. Forms Quick Reference

Form	Used for
RT3185	Reporting a signal, AWS, ERTMS or TPWS failure or irregularity — completed jointly by driver and signaller (S7 §7.8).
RT3188	'Activation of TPWS or ERTMS trip' — records the driver's answers after an on-track-equipment TPWS/ERTMS activation (S7 §6.5).
RT3973	Describes a dangerous or exceptional load and any associated working restrictions for that journey.

Compiled from EMR PPT 11-01 (Train Dispatch), 11-03 (Train Driving), and 11-04 (Planned/Unplanned Diversionary Routes), cross-referenced against GERT8000-SS1 Iss 10, S7 Iss 7, TW1 Iss 22 and SS2 Iss 7. Classroom-only group exercises and discussion prompts with no rule book answer have been omitted as not directly relevant to driving duties.